MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE

Approved 2/21/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Unapproved minutes
February 7, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m. by Chairman Jeff Haskell.

COMMISSIONERS PRESENT

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps and members of the public

PUBLIC COMMENT

Members of the public made suggestions on how medical services should be provided, how to fund emergency medical services and provided stories of personal incidents. Emergency Medical Personnel commented on what actually happens in an emergency situation and made suggestions of what services should be in place.

All 5 Fire Chiefs in Clare County were present and some of them provided input on the subject. The Fire Departments are called to help Mobile Medical Response (MMR) on many occasions.

Questions were asked including if a millage would add additional ambulances or fund the ones that are already stationed in Clare County.

Grant Township Supervisor Dan Dysinger and Greenwood Township Supervisor Jess McClaughry spoke against a county-wide millage for ambulance service.

JUSTICE

1. Public Hearing Regarding Emergency Medical Services
   County Administrator Lori Phelps explained the purpose of the meeting and set up guidelines for the meeting.

   It was explained that non-emergency use of ambulance services in Clare County is part of the problem. Some people call the ambulance to take them to the hospital because they don't have a vehicle or family members to take them to the doctor, so they call an ambulance and go to the hospital.

   Commissioner Haskell confirmed that Clare County does not currently contribute any funds toward ambulance services.

   MMR Representative Eric Snidersich VP of Operations confirmed they spent $4 million last year servicing Clare County and confirmed that the transfers they provide help pay the bills. Without transfers they would have been short $1.7 million last year. He also explained that in the event there were 6 calls at one time, MMR would pull resources from other areas to accommodate. The cost to MMR is $400.00 per hour to have an ambulance sitting before any resources are used.

JUSTICE - continued

1. Public Hearing Regarding Emergency Medical Services - continued

   MMR is trying to increase staff by paying people to go through EMT school and guarantee a job when they get complete the program. They also confirmed that only 5% of 911 calls are life threatening. Medical Board Authority Chairman Glenn King noted that 95% of response times are15 minutes or under. If an ambulance was stationed in every township the response time would improve, but that is not financially sustainable.

   New to the EMS Community is a Paramedicine Model where paramedics partner with doctors to take care of issue without transporting to a hospital. This option is being looked at and not currently available.

   It was agreed to form a committee and have a meeting with county commissioner board members, MMR, Medical Board Authority and Township Supervisors and talk about options.

   Administrator Phelps will send a letter and also ask for participation to the fire chiefs and 911 dispatchers. Commissioners Hoefling, Housler and Majewski will be on the Committee.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES

1. Discussion Middle Michigan Development Corporation
   In the past Clare County contributed $22,000.00 per year to Middle Michigan Development and then reduced their contribution to $12,500.00 per year. Middle Michigan Development Corporation is requesting Clare County reinstate funding to $22,000.00 per year. Administrator Phelps handed out their annual report.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:43 a.m.:

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners